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The contents of this book belong to Electric City Tang Soo Do excluding, The History of Tang Soo Do section taken from The Untold History of Tang Soo Do and The Stances section taken from The Physics of Tang Soo Do Stances both by Master Daniel R. Segarra.

Welcome to Electric City Tang Soo Do!

You've taken the first step on a journey that will lead you to a level of physical and mental self mastery that will influence every aspect of your life.

This manual has been prepared to help you on your journey. It outlines a basic timeline, etiquette, vocabulary, history, and rank requirements.

Introduction

The martial art we teach is Tang Soo Do.

Tang Soo Do Moo Duk Kwan, founded by Hwang Kee around 1945, is a Korean martial art that combines elements of shotokan karate, subak, taekkyon, and kung fu.

Tang Soo Do is a classical martial art and not a sport. It is not a game to be played, but rather an activity designed to foster individual physical and mental growth.

Owner / Head Instructor

Michael Simon began his Tang Soo Do training in 2003, under the direction of International Grandmaster Frank Trojanowicz (Dan #13333).
Michael has competed in Tournaments in the categories of Forms, Weapon Forms, Breaking, and Free Sparring, placing in many categories and specializing in Breaking.
Michael has been teaching children and adults since 2005.

Brief History of Martial Arts

Martial arts themselves cannot be attributed to any one place or person. They developed naturally around the world when needed. Martial arts began as an individual instinct then developed into tribal systems and eventually evolved into the various styles and systems you see today. As martial arts progressed, ancient and

modern Masters combined them with natural philosophies, based on a respect for nature, and focused on developing the practitioners into mature, centered human beings.

Although our martial art is relatively modern, its heritage goes back hundreds of years, combining the wisdom of China, Japan, Okinawa, Korea and combatives and philosophy from cultures all over the world.

From the wisdom of Confucius and Lao Tzu, to the code of the Samurai and the tenets of Koreas Hwa Rang warriors, Tang Soo Do's heritage and roots stretch far and wide.

Korean martial arts have a long and fascinating history, with many innovative

pioneers.

Japan occupied Korea from 1910 to 1945. Its rule was oppressive and brutal; not many people realize that Japan decimated the Korean culture, much like their allies the Germans did to the Jews during the holocaust. Koreans were forced to speak only Japanese in public and had to adopt a Japanese name.

History Of Tang Soo Do

Young Hwang Kee (황기 November 9, 1914 – July 14, 2002) born Tae Nam Hwang, into this tumultuous time, was one of Korea's greatest martial arts pioneers. He suffered many hardships but, at the age of seven, he saw something that changed his life.

While attending a village festival called 'Dan Oh', a group of ruffians began picking on a lone man. Suddenly this one man exploded into a flurry of kicks and spins defeating the attackers. Young Hwang Kee saw this person's amazing power against incredible odds and knew that he wanted to follow the same path. He approached this master of a martial art called 'Tae Kyun' but was rebuffed because he was too young. He spied on the Tae Kyun master's outdoor practice copying and learning in secret. For years, he trained in seclusion and sought out various Masters to learn from, but to no avail. Due to his father being a noted Korean scholar, young Hwang Kee was fortunate enough to be allowed to attend High school. Because of his good education, he was allowed to begin working for the Japanese controlled railroad:

The Minami Manshu Tetsudo Kabushiki-gaisha(南満州鉄道株式会社/南滿洲鉄道株式会社) .

His job at the railroad allowed him to travel somewhat freely, and while working in Japanese controlled Manchuria China (also named "Manchukuo" at that time), his martial arts future took a dramatic turn.

As luck would have it, his job traveling led him to find his future teacher in Manchuria, in an area called Jo Yang Chun in the Gilum (Jilin) province. In 1936, Master

Yang Kuk Jin (楊鞠振/楊麴震) was a well known master of northern Kung Fu, particularly Tai Chi and Tan Tui. Originally Master Yang politely rebuffed young Hwang Kee and his coworker and friend Park Hyo Pil's requests to become his students.

Not giving up, Hwang Kee and his friend kept showing up daily until Master Yang finally accepted them as students. Master Yang trained them in Bo Bup (stepping methods), Ryun Bup (conditioning methods), Dam Toi Ship Ee Ro (twelve long fist forms), and Tae Kuk Kwon (Tai Chi). Hwang Kee trained with Master Yang daily for a little over a year before having to return to Korea in 1937.

After the brutal Japanese occupation, Koreans wanted desperately to regain their identity. Hwang Kee, after his time training in China with Master Yang, began teaching in 1945 and originally promoted his style as Hwa Soo Do 花 手道, or "flowering hand way". The intended meaning was that students would grow, like a flower, into something beautiful. The name a nod to Korea's Hwa Rang warriors as well. Remnants of the Japanese conditioning remained among the Korean population. His
new style was not widely accepted and all his students quit. Disappointed, Hwang Kee searched for ways to continue teaching martial arts. As mentioned previously, Hwang Kee worked for the Korean Railroad, his coworkers Kim Un Chung, Kim Yong Duk and Choi Hee Suk had done some training during the Japanese occupation.

They began training with Hwang Kee in one of the small storage buildings owned by the Railroad. He realized from his past failed attempt at teaching Kung Fu (Hwa Soo Do) that he had hurdles to overcome.

He studied Karate books from the Railroad library. More than likely this was Gichin Funakoshis (船越 義珍) Karate Do Kyohan or his earlier works simply because Shotokan Karate was the only style of Karate permitted to be taught in Korea during the occupation.

Seeing how organized the Japanese Martial arts were, he befriended Lee Won Kuk a direct student of Funakoshi. Lee was the most successful Martial Arts instructor in Korea at that time and taught the Tang Soo Do Chung Do Kwan style. Tang Soo Do Chung Do Kwan was simply the Korean version of Japanese Shotokan style. This was evident in the use of kata (forms) & curriculum.

Hwang was so impressed with Lee's success he changed what he was teaching to Tang Soo Do and basically copied his curriculum. He did this understanding that the Korean people were not ready for something different like his first attempt Hwa Soo Do which resembled Kung Fu more than the Japanese style karate the Koreans were used to seeing at that time.

Now armed with a name (Tang Soo Do) and a curriculum borrowed from Chung Do Kwan, they were ready to teach. Hwang Kee assumed the leadership role as Kwan Jang Nim, as he was the head of the group and most experienced martial artist.

Since all four worked for the Korean railroad, they opened dojangs at various train station storage rooms & railroad owned buildings spreading their new organization. This allowed the organization to grow rapidly throughout Korea.

Hwang Kee's ability to harness his members resources helped them grow even further. He wrote various books, published a newspaper, and had a film produced for the American servicemen. He was way ahead of every other martial art style in Korea at the time.

In 1957, after seeing how well the Tang Soo Do style was accepted by American servicemen in Korea, Hwang Kee brilliantly tapped into this enthusiasm, eventually sending representatives to the USA to build an organization there. There was a charter meeting in 1975 to establish an organization in the USA for Tang Soo Do.



Pictured above are the participants of the charter meeting. Seated in the center is the founder of Tang Soo Do Grand Master (Kwan Jang Nim) Hwang Kee.

Seated on the floor, second from the right, is Grand Master Frank Trojanowicz, first instructor of Michael Simon, the owner of Electric City Tang Soo Do.

CLASS RULES

The following rules shall be observed while attending classes at
Electric City Tang Soo Do:

General Information

- All monthly dues shall be paid on or before the 1st of every month.
- No shoes will be permitted on the Do Jang (training area or karate school) floor.
- Always wear a clean uniform.
- Tradition suggests that martial artists not wash the belt as it may remove rank or achievement stripes but a light wash is recommended after a heavy work out.
- Never wear your Tang Soo Do belt without being in full uniform unless authorized by the instructor such as wearing a karate school t-shirt during the summer instead of the Do Bahk (uniform) jacket.
- Patches are to be displayed in the approved manner.
- Wearing watches, bracelets, and/or necklaces is prohibited. Wedding rings may be worn if turned inward or covered with tape. Only stud ear rings are permitted.

Attendance

- All students must attend a sufficient amount of classes during a testing period ,unless excused by the instructor, to qualify for the next rank testing.
- Students should inform the instructor if they are going to be absent from regular class sessions, especially for multiple absences.
- Emergencies are an exception but you must notify the instructor as soon as possible following the absence.

Cleanliness

- Practice good hygiene at all times.
- Keep fingernails and toenails trimmed, not only for good grooming, but also for safety.
- Wash hands before and after class.

Classroom Etiquette (Before Class)

- Students should arrive at least 15 minutes before class to stretch and prepare.
- Upon entering the karate school, be sure to sign in to ensure you get credit for the classes you attend. If any of your personal or contact information has changed such as name, address, telephone number, or e-mail address, notify your instructor.
- When ready to enter the training floor, salute the flags by placing your right fist over your heart and then bow. This demonstrates respect and appreciation for our country and our art. You should do this upon entering and leaving the Do Jang
- After bowing onto the floor, use that time before the start of class to warm up, stretch, work on forms, grab a partner and work on one steps, or any other requirements you may need to work on.
- When first entering the Do Jang floor you should always recognize senior members, especially black belts and masters. Greet them and bow. Shake hands if you choose.
- When shaking hands, extend your right arm to shake their hand and place your left hand palm open and down facing the floor under your right elbow.
- Never enter the Do Jang floor while a class is in progress or an instructor is engaged in teaching. Do not interrupt unless an emergency. Stand at the entry to the Do Jang floor and wait until the instructor acknowledges you and turns to bow you into the Do Jang floor. It is improper to attempt to get the Instructor's attention by speaking, a wave of the hand or other means. Wait quietly and patiently until you are acknowledged.
- When entering the Do Jang late stand at attention at the edge of the floor and do not enter the Do Jang floor until the instructor turns to you, bows, and acknowledges you to enter.
- If you enter the Do Jang after the class has begun and after you have been acknowledged and bowed in then you must line up at the end of the line on the back row unless otherwise instructed.
- When any master enters the Do Jang floor, any student must call attention to the master and turn and bow at once. This rule applies to any Tang Soo Do class, test, or Tang Soo Do function.
- All students waiting to begin class shall be respectful and remain quiet for other classes in session.
- No free sparring or use of equipment in the Do Jang without the approval of the instructor.
- **Parents are not allowed to instruct their children during class!!!**

Classroom Etiquette (During Class)

- If leaving class early, or leaving room briefly, approach the instructor and ask for permission after bowing first, or discuss with instructor before class. Emergencies are always an exception.
- While on the Do Jang floor, instructors and black belts shall be addressed by Mr., Mrs., Miss, or Master (also Sir, Ma'am, Kyo Sa Nim, Sa Bom Nim, Kwan Ja Nim, or Nim)
- No talking in class unless authorized by the class instructor.
- When training, try to clear your mind of any problems outside of the Do Jang.
- Bow before speaking to anyone on the Do Jang floor.
- When your belt or uniform needs to be straightened, bow, turn clockwise away from your instructor or other students while making the uniform or belt adjustments, then turn back and bow again, but only during an appropriate pause in instruction or training (always turn to the right and then back to the right making a complete circle).
- When asking a question in class raise your hand. When called upon bow to the instructor and ask your question. When your question has been answered say "Thank you Sir/Ma'am" and bow to the instructor. If seated when asking a question, raise your hand, when called upon stand, bow, and ask your question, after your question is answered say "Thank You Sir/Ma'am" bow to instructor and be seated.
- Turn off all cell phones in Do Jang.
- Keep temper and bad attitudes under control. Both are harmful not only to you, but to those who are training with you and they can cause accidents. There shall be no profanity used anywhere in the Do Jang.
- There shall be no alcohol or drugs consumed/used before or while attending class.
- No gum or food is allowed in the Do Jang; however, water or a hydrating drink is encouraged and may be kept at the side of the Do Jang floor or in a safe place so that it is not a hazard to other students.
- If a member of another Tang Soo Do school comes to visit, treat them as you would a member of your own school.
- If you attend class at another Tang Soo Do school, behave in a manner befitting your rank.

Classroom Etiquette (After Class)

- When leaving the Do Jang floor, leave by rank in an orderly and calm manner. Turn to the Do Jang floor from the exit, bow, and salute the flags before leaving.
- If the instructor has asked you to assist in cleanup of any kind please do so without fuss or hesitation. This is part of your training and is expected of all students. You should take pride in your Do Jang as it is where you learn and grow in the martial arts.

Outside the Classroom

- It is not permitted to use Tang Soo Do techniques outside of class unless it is a true instance of self-defense. All use of Tang Soo Do techniques outside the classroom must be reported to the Master in charge of the Do Jang.
- Never wear your uniform or belt outside of class. Uniform pants may be worn to and from the Do Jang.
- Do not engage in any activity that might degrade your reputation as you represent the school.
- All students must be gang free.

At Electric City Tang Soo Do we teach our students to live by the following:

5 Codes of Tang Soo Do

1) Loyalty to Country
2) Obedience to Parents
3) Honor Friendship
4) No Retreat in Battle
5) In Conflict, Choose with Sense & Honor

7 Tenets of Tang Soo Do

1) Integrity
2) Concentration
3) Perseverance
4) Respect & Obedience
5) Self Control
6) Humility
7) Indomitable spirit

5 Codes of Tang Soo Do

1. **Loyalty to country** - Country implies community, neighbor, society, country. (faithfulness, devotion, sincerity, patriotism, contribution)
2. **Obedience to parents** - Parents implies father, mother, teacher, elders, and instructors. (respect for others, esteem, honor, appreciation.)
3. **Honor friendship** - Friends implies associates, colleagues, brothers, sisters. (brotherhood, sisterhood, trust, unity, responsibility, credibility, humility.) 4. **No retreat in battle** - Battle signifies job, duty, responsibility, goal, ideal. (determination, perseverance, duty, courage.)
5. **In conflict, choose with sense and honor** - Conflict can mean use of Tang Soo Do to defend oneself or others, it can also mean and internal or moral conflict. (humanity, mercy, wisdom.)

7 Tenets of Tang Soo Do

1. **Integrity** – The quality of being honest and having strong moral principles. (Always do the right thing)
2. **Concentration** - The action or power of focusing one's attention or mental effort. (Focus on what you're doing and don't get distracted)
3. **Perseverance** - Steadfastness in doing something despite difficulty or delay in achieving success. (Never give up as no matter how hard things get)
4. **Respect and Obedience** - a feeling of deep admiration for someone or something elicited by their abilities, qualities, or achievements. AND compliance with an order, request, or law or submission to another's authority. (we treat everyone the way we want to be treated and listen to those in authority)
5. **Self-Control** - the ability to control oneself, in particular one's emotions and desires or the expression of them in one's behavior, esp. in difficult situations. (Control your self. Restraint and concentration are examples)
6. **Humility** - a modest or low view of one's own importance; humbleness. (Don't be boastful or show off)
7. **Indomitable Spirit** - a spirit that cannot be subdued or overcome, as persons, will, or courage; unconquerable. (Be strong inside and never let things stop you from achieving your goals)

Korean Terminology

General Terminology

Tang Soo Do ..... Name of the art we study

Nim ..... Term of respect (i.e. Sir or Ma'am)

Kwan Jang Nim ..... Grand Master

Sa Bom Nim ..... Master Instructor (4th Dan and up)

Kyo Sa Nim ..... Instructor (2nd Dan and up)

Jo Kyo Nim ..... Assistant Instructor

Shim Sa Kwan Nim ..... Judge/Examiner

Dan ..... Black belt rank

Gup ..... Color belt rank

Do Jang ..... Training Hall (school/studio)

Do Bahk ..... Uniform

Dee ..... Belt

Kuk Gi ..... Flag

Hyung ..... Form

Ki Hap ..... Yell

Commands In Starting And Ending Class

Cha Ryut ..... Attention

Kuk Gi Bae Reh ..... Salute the flag

Ba Ro ..... Return

An Ju ..... Sit

Muk Nyum ..... Meditation

(Title) Keh Kyung Nyet .....Bow to (Title)

Commands In Training

Kyung Nyet ..... Bow

Choon Bee ..... Ready (get into Choon Bee Jaseh)

Si Jak ..... Begin

Shio ..... Relax

Dwi Ro Tora ..... Turn to rear

Stances

Choon Bee Jaseh ..... Ready Stance

Chun Gul Jaseh…… ..... Front Stance

Hu Gul Jaseh……..Fighting/Back Stance

Kee Ma Jaseh ..... Horse Stance

Korean Numbers

Ha Na ..... One

Dool ..... Two

Set ..... Three

Net ..... Four

Da Sot ..... Five

Yuh Sot ..... Six

Il Gop ..... Seven

Yo Dull ..... Eight

Ah Hap ..... Nine

Yohl..... Ten

Basic Action Commands

Mahk Kee ..... Block

Kong Kyuk……..Attack/Strike

Cha Gi ..... Kick

Ha Dan..... Low section

Choong Dan ..... Middle section

Sang Dan ..... High Section

Blocks

Ha Dan Mahk Kee ..... Low block

Sang Dan Mahk Kee ..... High block

Ahneso Pahkuro Mahk Kee ..... Inside-Outside block

Pahkeso Ahnero Mahk Kee ..... Outside-Inside block

Soo Do Mahk Kee……..Knife hand block

Hand Techniques

Choong Dan Kong Kyuk ..... Middle punch

Sang Dan Kong Kyuk ..... High punch

Kwan Soo Kong Kyuk ..... Spear hand

Soo Do Kong Kyuk ..... Knife hand

Yuk Soo Do Kong Kyuk ..... Ridge hand/reverse knife hand

Cap Kwon ..... Back fist

Kwon Do ..... Hammer fist

(*To indicate a block from a stance other than front stance the name of the stance is added to the beginning of the above I.e. Hu Gul Ha Dan Mahk Kee or low block in fighting/back stance)

Kicks

(*The addition of the term E Dan indicates a jumping kick. i.e Ee dan Ahp Cha Gi—Jump front kick)

Ahp Cha Gi ..... Front kick

Yup Cha Gi ..... Side kick

Dullyo Cha Gi ..... Round kick

Dwi Cha Gi ..... Back kick

Ahneso Pakero Cha Gi ..... Inside-Outside kick

Pakeso Ahnero Cha Gi ..... Outside-Inside kick

Yup Hu Ri Gi ..... Hook kick

Peet Cha Gi ..... Reverse round kick

Courtesy and Respect

Kahm Sa Ham Ni Da ..... Thank you

All of the above terms may be used in class along with others. The pronunciations are not given, so you may learn them by hearing them. This chart is simply used for reference.



Flags and Meanings

American Flag



The 50 stars represent the number of states. The 13 alternating white and red stripes represent the original 13 colonies. The colors of the flag have meaning as well: Red symbolizes Hardiness and Valor. White symbolizes Purity and Innocence. Blue represents Vigilance, Perseverance and Justice.

South Korean Flag



The white background represents purity and peace or emptiness. The concept of emptiness is an important one in martial arts because one must empty ones mind or preconceived notions before true learning and growth can occur. In the center of the flag lies a Taeguk, a symbol for balance and harmony. The symbols ,or trigrams, in the corners are known as kwae and are taken from the ancient book of thought , the Chu Yok (Chinese I Ching). Representing the four classical elements and the seasons, They are heaven/spring (3 solid bars), fire/autumn (2 solid bars with split middle bar), water /winter (2 split bars with solid middle bar) and earth/summer (3 split bars).

Uniform

The Uniform is properly called a Do Bahk. This is a composite word, combining Do "way of life" and Bahk "apparel" or "clothing."

The word "Gi" is the japanese term for uniform and is inappropriate for use in our art.

The Do Bok is the symbol of your commitment to mental and physical selfimprovement. The traditional white color of the Do Bok has been maintained since ancient times. The white color represents the practitioner's respect for Iife, purity
of spirit and commitment to avoid unjust conflict. You should always wear your Do Bok with pride and respect it as you do your own body. Keep it clean and in good shape. To be proud of your outside appearance can only mean you feel good on the inside.

Patches

All patches should be attached to your uniform as soon as possible Wash the uniform in cold water before sewing the patches on the student uniform.

Do not wash the belt.

Do not wash or dry the uniform on hot. The uniform may shrink.

Cold water wash is best.

Chest Patch – Tape or pin this patch on while the uniform top is being worn by the student. Tie the belt on before positioning the patch. Tie the top as it should be worn. Tie at the sides. Tie the belt around the waist and pin the patch in place. The patch is worn over the area of the heart on the left front panel.

Association Patch - If an association patch is desired it should be placed on the right or left sleeve just below the seam.

Additional Information:

Hem the sleeves and the pants if necessary. The uniform should not be worn with the sleeves or the pants rolled up for safety reasons. (Please talk to instructor if you feel your child may grow and you don't want to hem the uniform)

2. Do not wash with bleach as it will fade the patches and rear logo design.
3. Keep your uniform clean. (not necessarily freshly washed but free of stains and odor). Your uniform is to be worn only at class.
4. A plain tee shirt is to be worn under the uniform top. The tee shirt must be presentable outer wear not underwear. The school tee shirt may also be worn under the top.
5. All students must wear underpants or shorts under the uniform pants.
6. Very important – no jewelry made from metal, plastic, clothe, string, paper…This is a safety issue. Our aim is to keep the students safe. Speak with instructor if you have any questions.
7. Hygiene and safety of all members - keep fingernails and toenails clean, short, and file all sharp edges smooth.

The Belt

The belt also known as Dee in Korean is an important part of your uniform. It not only helps to hold your uniform together but it gives you an idea of where you are on your journey in the martial arts.

Your belt should be washed after a heavy work out on a gentle cycle and air dried if possible.

Make sure your rank stripes, if any, hang to the left when your belt is tied

How to tie your belt*

Often times newer students lose focus during class times to tie their belt. This little "how to" will help you learn how to tie your belt successfully so that you only need do it once per lesson

1. Before you tie your belt make sure your jacket is tied correctly and securely.
2. Fold your belt in half.
3. Open the belt and place the half way point slightly below your bellybutton (if you have a rank stripe it should hang on the right side)
4. Wrap the belt ends around your back, cross them and bring them around to the front. Slide your hands along the belt to make sure it doesn't twist. Ends should be the same length when brought to the front.
5. Cross both ends in front of you with the right end on top.
6. Take the top end and tuck it underneath both layers of the belt and up towards your face, this should be now the nearest part to your abdomen.
7. To finish simply tie a knot. Both ends should hang at equal length (Rank stripes on the left, achievement stripes on the right)

*Keep in mind the best way to learn is to ask your instructor to teach you.

We also have a video on our website in the "White Belt" section to show you how to tie your belt or tie a belt onto someone else.

Below you will find the belt system laid out and the meanings of the different colored belts:

10th Gup - White Belt

9th Gup - White Belt with one stripe

8th Gup - Orange Belt

7th Gup - Orange Belt with one stripe

6th Gup - Green Belt

5th Gup - Green Belt with one stripe

4th Gup - Green Belt with two stripes

3rd Gup - Red Belt

2nd Gup - Red Belt with one stripe

1st Gup - Red Belt with two stripes

Cho Dan Bo - Red Belt with three stripes (designates candidate for black belt)

1st Dan - 1st Degree Black Belt through 3rd Dan - 3rd Degree Black Belt (designated by rank stripes on the black belt)

Some schools use a midnight blue belt instead of black.

4th Dan - 4th Degree Black Belt and above are considered master ranks and are designated by a red stripe through the center of the black belt.

In our school once you reach 4th Dan you will keep that belt through the rest of your training. Some schools may also have alternate belts for 6th Dan and above.

*ranks with this designation are not formally tested for but are awarded in class at the instructors discretion unless following the young children's curriculum.

The four original colors were:

White is Winter it signifies emptiness, innocence, hidden potential, and purity

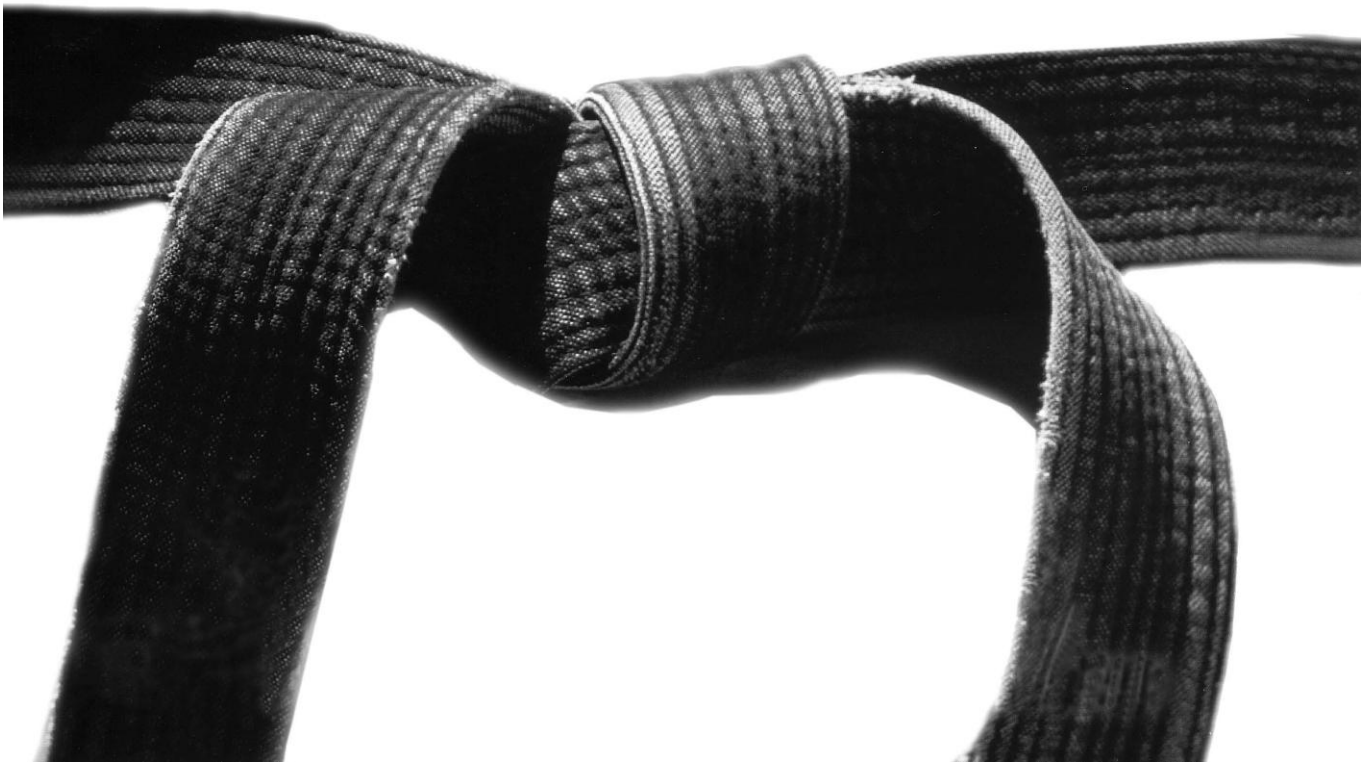
Green is Spring it signifies growth, spreading, advancement **Red**

is Summer it signifies ripening, “yang”, active

Black is Autumn it signifies harvest, maturity, “um”, passive

*many schools have added colors along the way. Orange was added in 1975 to give another stepping stone for students to lessen the amount of material between white and green belt.

* as a note the terms “yang” and “um” correspond to the red and blue in the Korean flag. Yang being the red, hard aspects of our style. Um being the blue, softer aspects of our style



Elements of Tang Soo Do Training

Hyungs

Hyungs or forms are an integral part of Tang Soo Do training. Hyungs are a set of moves demonstrating a defensive or aggressive action for every movement . They are based on an offender attacking and one demonstrating the form reacting to their attack. The training of forms gives you an opportunity to work all aspects of the martial arts, including focus, timing, balance, etc. Forms also give you a chance to work on all of your physical techniques (i.e. kicks, blocks, etc.) Some points about Hyung training :

- Concentration is essential
- Every attempt at a Hyung requires maximum effort
- Perfection requires continues practice
- Patience is as important as physical ability in developing a perfect Hyung
- Develop your own psychological technique to overcome idleness, distractions, and mental block.
- After practice learn to relax and to appreciate the gains you have made, no matter how small.

One Steps

These techniques are developed by individual instructors and are not standard in Tang Soo Do. One-step sparring techniques are best described as a choreographed pattern of defense moves against the single step of an attack. Usually performed in pairs, this begins with a bow for respect. One partner then attacks, often with a simple punch, and the other person will perform a series of premeditated techniques.

Weapons

Tang Soo Do does not traditionally have weapons. Some schools have added weapons training to their curriculum. In our school we teach aspects of the Filipino martial art of Arnis

Point-Sparring

Tang Soo Do point-sparring is similar to competitive matches in other traditional Okinawan, Japanese and Korean striking systems and may include elements of American freestyle point karate. Tang Soo Do sparring consists of point matches that are based on the three-point rule (the first contestant to score three points wins) or a two-minute rule (a tally of points over one two-minute round). Lead and rear-leg kicks and lead and rear-arm hand techniques all score equally (one point per technique). However, to encourage the use of jumping and spinning kicks, these techniques may be scored with a higher point value than standing techniques in some competitions. Most point sparring events have their own unique rules outlining forbidden techniques and scoring.

Free Sparring

Free Sparring is similar to point sparring but no score is kept. No contact to light or moderate contact is used and students simulate a real fight using all techniques they have learned and reacting to their opponents techniques.

Self Defense

Self Defense techniques just as One Steps are developed by individual instructors and are not standard in Tang Soo Do. They are simulations of situations where one must defend themselves or others from harm. Either against a punch, kick, grab, or hold of some sort.

Breaking

Board breaking using different kicks and hand strikes traditionally is done during promotional testing. Breaking demonstrates correct application of technique, power, and focus. A person can have great power, but if he or she lacks focus or technique, they will not break. As you progress through the ranks your breaking requirements become more difficult.

What is a stance?

A stance is whatever posture your body is in, in that moment. Over the years martial arts masters have come to realize which postures are the most effective. By observing human movement and applying natural laws ancient martial arts masters have helped develop and systemize what techniques work most effectively.

Stances can be static or dynamic. The goal of the stance is for you to maintain enough balance to either effectively defend yourself or attack your opponent.

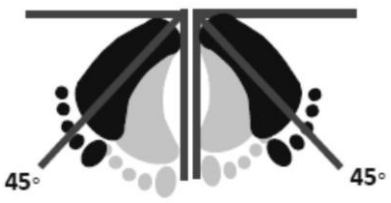
The effectiveness of your stance will greatly impact each and every technique you do. It is your foundation. Improve your foundation and everything you do will improve, ignore your foundation and everything you do will suffer. By making even a small improvement in your stances everything you do will get better.

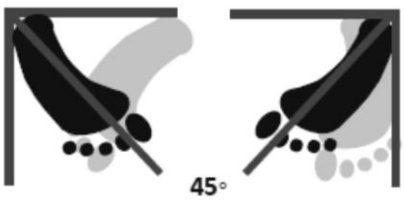
Measurements

In Tang Soo Do Volume one Grandmaster Hwang Kee used actual measurements in the form of metrics to give examples of distances in stances. The challenge with that is everyone is of differing sizes and shapes so unless you are the same exact size as the model for which he based these measurements on you would need to recalculate the distances for yourself.

In this manual we will be using our own foot measurements for the exact distances for each stance. Since your own feet are your own base this is both practical and customized to your individual needs. Note the measurements are to teach you the distance. <u>This is NOT how you regularly enter the stances.</u>

For our needs we will break the pivots down to a) toes out (one pivot), b) toes in (one pivot), and c) toes straight (1/2 pivot). Each pivot the feet will move 45 degrees and on the half pivot turn straight ahead.





Stances

The main stances used in Tang Soo Do are Ready Stance/Choon Bee Jaseh, Front Stance/Chun Gul Jaseh, Fighting Stance/Hu Gul Jaseh, and Horse Stance/Kee Ma Jaseh.

For all stances the starting position, unless otherwise noted, will be attention stance. Attention stance would be having hands at your side, back up straight, and your feet together.

Stance Energetics

The study of the stances cannot be fully addressed without discussing the energetics of the stances. Unnecessary tension or misplaced tension in the body can throw one off balance. Grandmaster Hwang Kee was fond of quoting this line from the
song of the thirteen energies. “Imagine the head as if suspended by a string.” This simple statement is a profound one and if fully understood can dramatically improve your training, health and life. Think of a weight held by a string, a pendulum if you will. The string will be naturally straight and in harmony with the forces of gravity because of the downward pulling force. Applying this concept to our posture will naturally straighten the spine and correct poor postural habits.

Mental focus should also be on the Dan Jun (abdomen) when training as to not allow tension/energy to rise and make one top heavy or stiff. Imagine throwing a ball. You transfer your weight, the arm is relaxed, the ball is released, and the arm is still relaxed. Relaxation is key to throwing correctly. Now when executing a punch if you are too tense it will slow down the motion. If you are tense after you waste energy. So we need to understand when to tense and when to relax to maximize our power and use of our energy properly.

Ready Stance/Choon Bee Jaseh



Choon Bee Jaseh is one and a half foot pivots from the attention stance equaling one shoulder widths. This is your everyday standing stance.

The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the middle of the base. Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun
(center) as upper body tension will cause you to be top heavy and unstable. Fists should be around waist level roughly a fists distance away from each other and a fists distance from your body

The Choon Bee/Pa Ro Jaseh (ready/return stance) can also be two and one half foot pivots for more stability. Find the positon you are comfortable in. these measurements are more guidelines to help you find the proper distance for your stances more so than hard and fast rules.



1



2



3

Fighting Stance/Hu Gul Jaseh



Hu Gul Jaseh is one and a half foot pivots from the attention stance equaling one shoulder width. Then the heel is pivoted with the majority of the weight shifted to one leg while the ball of the opposite foot lightly rests on the ground. The knees should be bent so when looking down you do not see your toes. The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the middle of the base (in this case the balancing leg). Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun (center).



1



2



3



4



5

Horse Stance/ Kee Ma Jaseh



Kee Ma Jaseh is 3 ½ foot pivots from the attention stance equaling two shoulder widths. The knees should be bent so when looking down you do not see your toes. The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the middle of the base. Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun
(center) as upper body tension will cause you to be top heavy and unstable. Think as if you are sitting in a horse's saddle so your weight is constantly pushing down verse holding a static posture like a cardboard cutout.



1



2



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4



5

Front Stance/ Chun Gul Jaseh



From the Kee Ma Jaseh (horse stance) pivot on the balls of the feet 45°. Shift the weight forward towards the front leg until if looking down you cannot see your toes. The rear leg will then naturally straighten. The spine should be straight and the hips tucked under naturally to keep the centerline over the base. Your energy should be focused in your Dan Jun (center) as upper body tension will cause you to be top heavy and unstable. Think as if you were pushing something forward with your hips.

Your head, shoulder, hips, and feet should all point forward.



1



2



3



4



5



6

Testing

A students eligibility to test is determined by their instructor. The instructor evaluates many aspects of the students training for consideration for rank advancement. For example, overall performance, attendance, behavior, maturity, etc.

- A promotion test will be offered every 3 months for those students who qualify.
- Students will be notified in advance if they qualify for testing.
- **TESTING FEES ARE NOT INCLUDED IN THE MONTHLY TUITION!!!!**
- At test time, if not already paid, have your testing fees ready before you sign in.
- During test days, absolutely no talking is permitted in the Do Jang or Do Jang waiting area, except for speaking directly with the instructor or members of the exam board at the test table and only for the purpose of conducting testing business.
- All class etiquette rules apply during testing, except there will be no talking.

Certifications

In addition to rank certification, students may be awarded teaching certifications.

Jo Kyo or Assistant Instructor certification may be awarded at the red belt level. Minimum age requirement is 13.

Kyo sa or Instructor certification may be awarded at the 2nd Dan level. Minimum age requirement is 18.

Sa Bom or Master Instructor certification may be awarded at the 4th Dan level.

Rank Requirements

Basic rank requirements are listed for each belt level on the following pages. Requirements may be amended for each student based on the instructors discretion and assessment of each students skill level. Requirements are subject to change as we grow and adapt our curriculum. Requirements for 9th-7th Gup will often be combined into one test if a student is capable.

10th Gup White-9th Gup White Belt (1 Stripe) Requirements

(This rank may be awarded in class and not officially tested for)

Forms:

Gi Cho Hyung Il Bu

Hand Techniques:

Low Block
Middle Punch

Foot Techniques:

Front Stretch Kick
Front Snap Kick

One Steps Hand:

#1

One Steps Foot:

#1

Breaks:

Breaking is not required for this rank.

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidate should be able to explain their understanding of the following:

1. What is the name of the art you study?

Answer: Tang Soo Do

9th Gup White (1 stripe)-8th Gup Orange Belt Requirements

Forms:

Gi Cho Hyung Ee Bu

Hand Techniques:

High Block
High Punch

Foot Techniques:

Round Kick
Outside to Inside Kick

One Steps Hand:

#2

One Steps Foot:

#2

Breaks:

Breaking is not required for this rank.

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidates should be able to explain their understanding of the following:

1. What does the word Do Jang mean

Answer: School or Training hall

8th Gup Orange-7th Gup Orange Belt (1 stripe) Requirements

(This rank may be awarded in class and not officially tested for)

Forms:

Gi Cho Hyung Sam Bu

Hand Techniques:

Inside to Outside Block
Outside to Inside Block

Foot Techniques:

Inside to Outside Kick
Side stretch Kick

One Steps Hand:

#3 & #4

One Steps Foot:

#3 & #4

Breaks:

Hammer Fist
Front Kick

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidates should be able to explain their understanding of the following:

1. What does the word Do Bahk mean?
   Answer: Uniform

2. What is the protocol for entering and leaving the Do Jang floor?
   Answer: Bow and salute the flags

7th Gup Orange (1 Stripe)-6th Gup Green Belt Requirements

Forms:

Pyung Ahn Cho Dan

Hand Techniques:

Side Punch
Elbow
Low Knife Hand Block
Hammer Fist

Foot Techniques:

Side Kick
Jump Front Kick
Back Kick

One Steps Hand:

#5 & #6

One Steps Foot:

#5 & #6

Breaks:

Step Behind Side Kick, Back Kick, or Palm Strike

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidates should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Count from 1-10 in Korean
2. Know 5 Codes and 7 Tenets and their meanings
3. Be familiar with the commands for starting/ending class
4. What does the word Kyung Reh mean? Answer: Bow
5. What does the word Si Jak mean? Answer: Begin/Start

6th Green-5th Green (1 Stripe) Belt Requirements

Forms:

Pyung Ahn Ee Dan

Hand Techniques:

Middle Knife Hand Block
Spear Hand Strike
Inside and Outside Knife Hand Strikes

Foot Techniques:

Jump Side Kick

One Steps Hand:

#7 & #8

One Steps Foot:

#7 & #8

Breaks:

Double Break:
Middle Punch/Step behind Side Kick

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidates should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Why do you bow before entering the Do Jang?
2. What are the belt colors and their meanings?
3. What do the titles Kwan Jang Nim, Sa Bom Nim, Kyo Sa Nim, and Jo Kyo Nim mean?

5th Gup Green (1 Stripe)-4th Gup Green (2 Stripes) Requirements

Forms:

Pyung Ahn Sam Dan

Hand Techniques:

High Knife Hand Block
High X Block

Foot Techniques:

Hook Kick

One Steps Hand:

#9 & #10

One Steps Foot:

#9 & #10

Breaks:

Double Break:
Knife Hand/Spinning Back Kick
Round Kick

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidates should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Be familiar with Basic Terminology

4th Gup Green (2 Stripes)-3rd Gup Red Requirements

Forms:

Pyung Ahn Sa Dan

Hand Techniques:

Back Fist

Foot Techniques:

Spinning Axe Kick
Jump Roundhouse Kick
Jump Inside to Outside Kick

One Steps Hand:

#11 & #12

One Steps Foot:

#11 & #12

Breaks:

Hook Kick
Jump Back Kick

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidates should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Be familiar with the basic history of Tang Soo Do

3rd Red-2nd Red (1 Stripe) Belt Requirements

Forms:

Pyung Ahn Oh Dan

Hand Techniques:

All lower level techniques

Foot Techniques:

Jump Back Kick
Jump Spinning Axe Kick
Jump Spinning Hook Kick

One Steps Hand:

#13 & #14

One Steps Foot:

#13 & #14

Breaks:

Double Break:
Standing or Step Behind Side Kick/Step Behind Hook Kick with opposite leg
Ridge Hand

2nd Gup Red (1 Stripe)-1st Gup Red (2 Stripes) Belt Requirements

Forms:

Bassai So

Hand Techniques:

All lower level Techniques

Foot Techniques:

Reverse Round Kick

Kicks:

Spinning Axe Kick with the back leg in Fighting Stance
Jump Spinning Hook Kick (360) off the back leg with a fake in Fighting Stance

One Steps Hand:

#15 & #16

One Steps Foot:

#15 & #16

Breaks:

Double Break:
Ridge Hand/Jump Spinning Back Kick (Right Leg)

1st Gup Red (2 Stripes)-Cho Dan Bo (3 Stripes) Belt Requirements

Forms:

Bassai Dae

One Steps Hand:

#17 & #18

One Steps Foot:

#17 & #18

Breaking:

Breaking is not required for this rank.

Cho Dan Bo (3 Stripes)-1st Dan - Cho Dan Requirements

Forms:

All previous hyung and
Nai Hanji Cho Dan

Kicks:

Spinning Axe Kick with the back leg in Fighting Stance
Jump Spinning Hook Kick (360) off the back leg with a fake in Fighting Stance

One Steps Hand:

All previous one steps and
#19 & #20

One Steps Foot:

All previous one steps and
#19 & #20

Self Defense:

The black belt candidate will be presented with several self defense scenarios to demonstrate their knowledge and abilities.

Breaks:

Candidates will be required to do several breaking techniques.
One hand, one foot, one jump, and one of the instructors choosing

Culture, Terminology, and History

Candidate should be able to explain his or her understanding of the following:

1. Essay: What does a black belt mean to me?

Don’t forget to visit our website.

www.ElectricCityTSD.com

You can find links to process payment for your monthly tuition and testing fees as well as a link to purchase apparel with the school logo.

Visit our Student section on the website and enter password

“Tangsoodo”

You will find video references for all rank requirements.

Please use these videos as a reference for your at home practice of the requirements you have learned in class and do not try to learn ahead.

Martial arts is not about the quantity of what you know but how well you know what you have learned.

Notes: